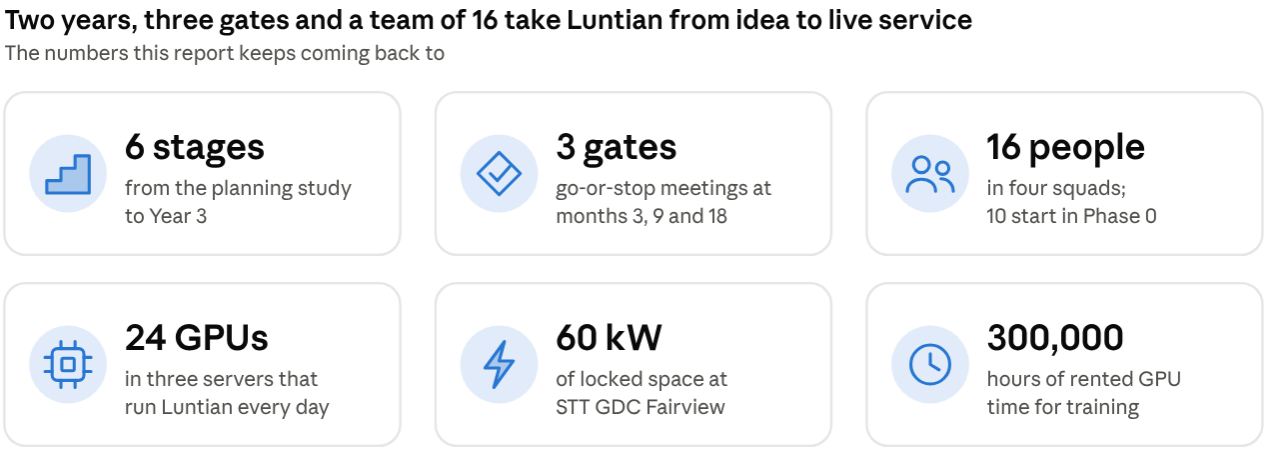
Project Luntian: How We Do It, Step by Step

Prepared by Reekhil Khanna, October 2026

This is the full report on how to do it, step by step: what happens at each stage, who does it, what it needs, and what must be true before the next stage starts. It goes with the proposal, Project Luntian: The Proposal in Plain Words.



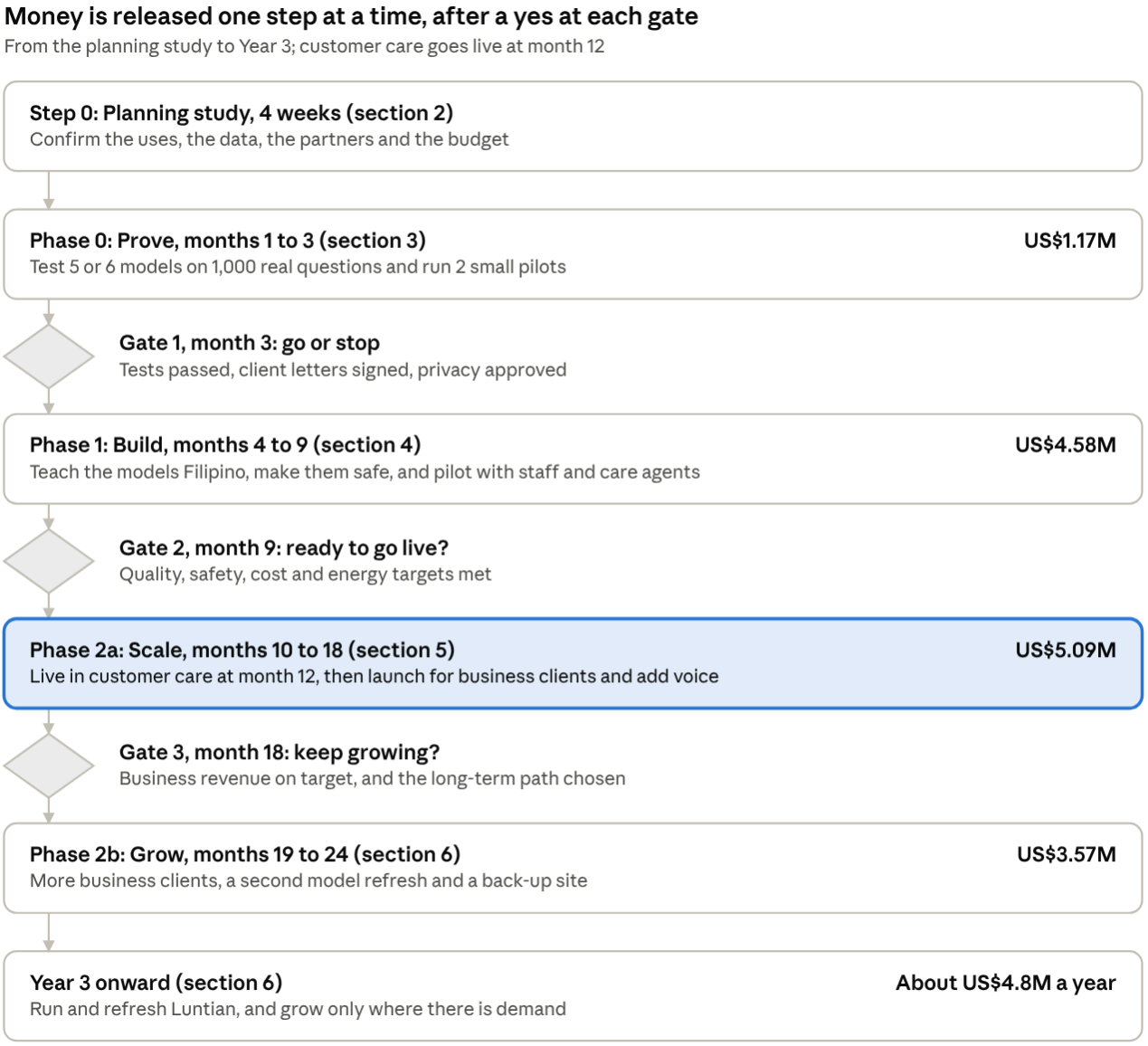
The plan in six numbers

Everything below explains how these numbers come together, stage by stage.

For a quick look first, the one-page website Project Luntian tells the same story as a comic in about five minutes.

1. How to use this report

The project runs in six stages over two years, and each stage in sections 2 to 6 is written the same way: the goal, what happens and who does it, what it needs, and the checklist that must be true before the next stage starts.

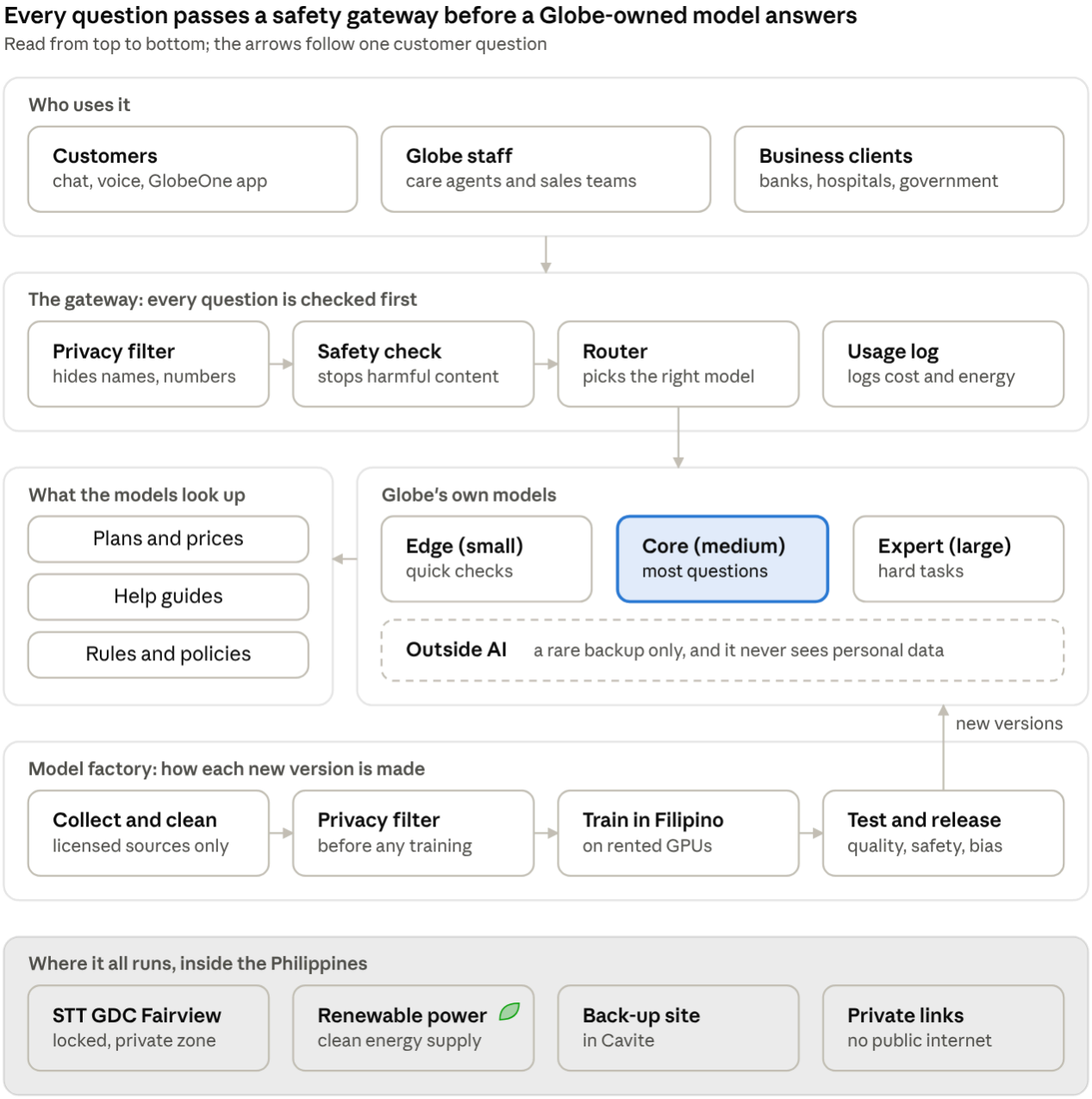


The six stages of Project Luntian, with three gates

Sections 7 to 12 then cover the team, how the AI is trained, what to buy, the safety rules, what could go wrong, and the words you may not know.

What we are building

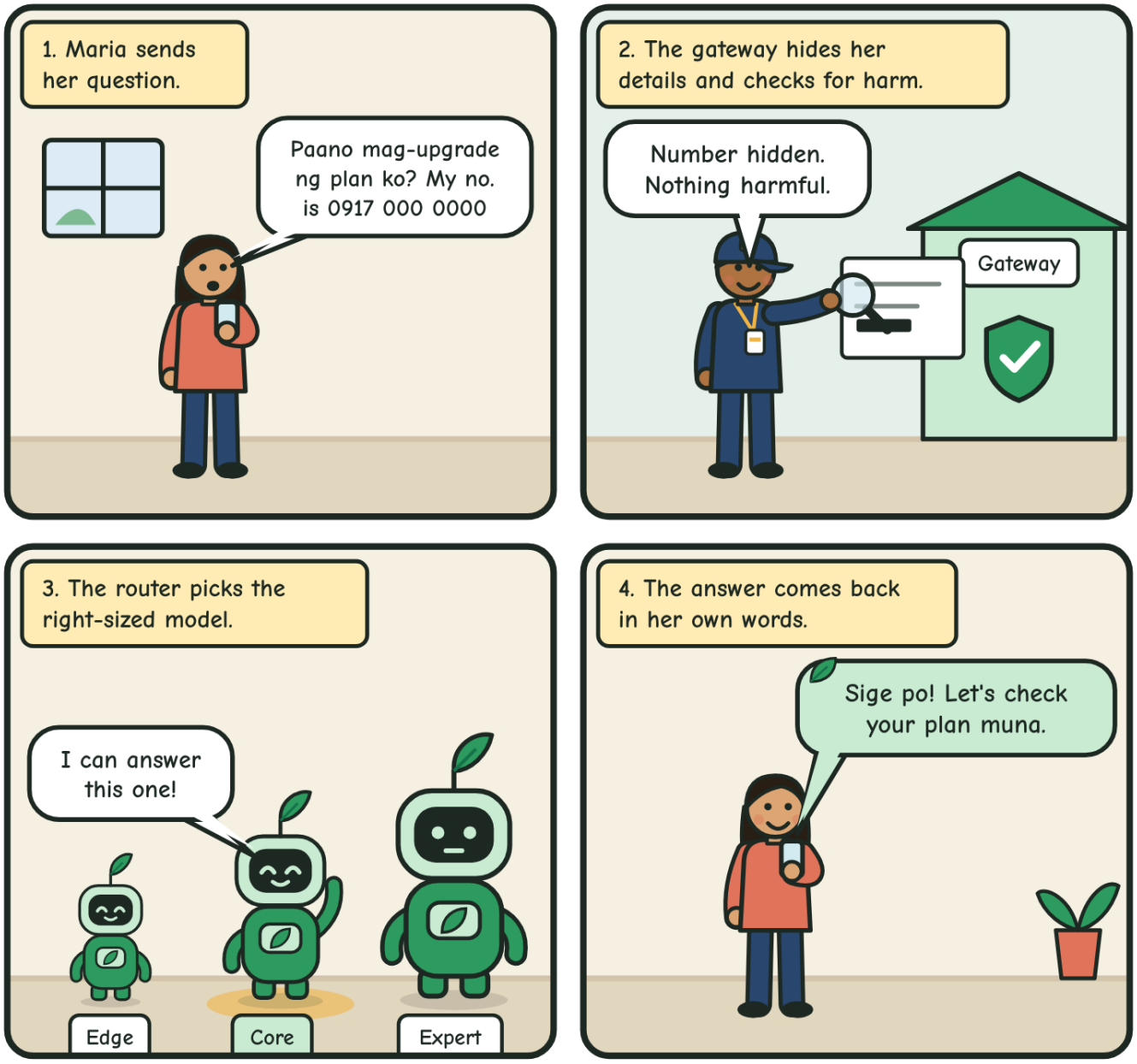
Before the steps, here is the system they build, in one picture.



What we are building: the whole system in one picture

Everyone comes in through one gateway, which hides personal details, blocks harmful content and sends each question to the right Globe model. The model factory near the bottom is where most of the work in sections 3 to 6 and section 8 happens, and section 9 explains the data centre at the bottom.

The same journey as a comic, following one customer question:



2. Step 0: Planning study (4 weeks)

Goal: agree what Luntian should do first, and get Phase 0 ready to approve.

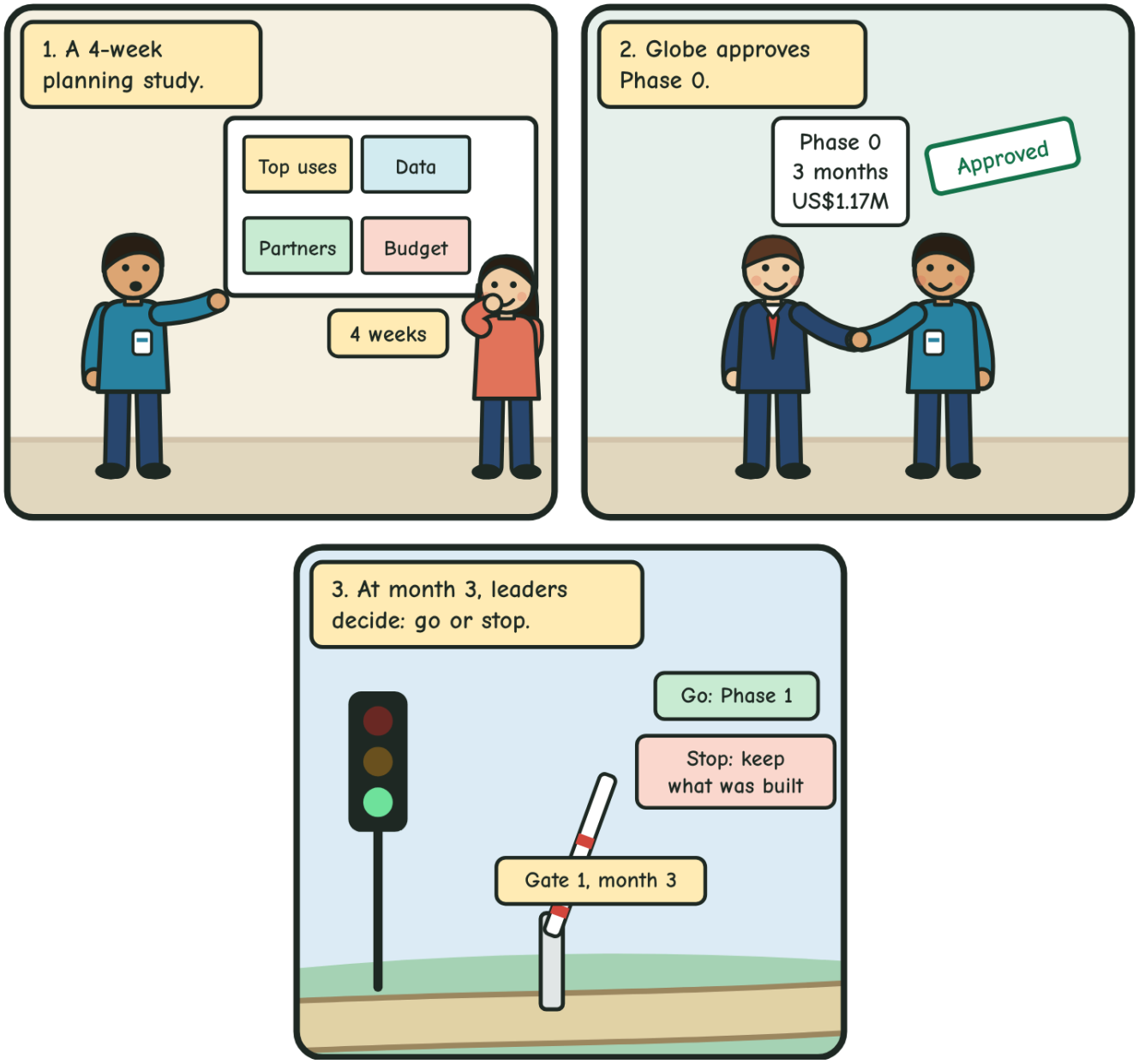
Who: the programme lead, Reekhil Khanna, with Globe's care, marketing, business, IT and privacy leads.

Week	What happens
1	Meet the care, marketing, business and IT leads; agree what success looks like and how to measure it

Week	What happens
2	List the data Globe could use, and check the privacy rules for each source
3	Shortlist partners and models; quick tests of two or three models on sample questions with no personal data
4	Write the Phase 0 plan, budget and Gate 1 targets, and present them to the sponsor

What it needs from Globe: a senior sponsor, two hours a week from a care lead and a marketing lead, and sample data under a confidentiality agreement.

What Globe gets at the end: a named sponsor, the top three uses with targets, a data and privacy check, a partner and model shortlist, and a Phase 0 plan ready to approve.



3. Phase 0: Prove (months 1 to 3)

Goal: find out whether an adapted open model can do Globe's Filipino work well, safely and at a good price.

Money: US$1.17M (₱73M). **Team:** 10 people.

When	What happens	Who does it
Weeks 1 to 2	Set up the team, and agree targets with the sponsor	Programme lead
Weeks 1 to 6	List every data source and check it against privacy law	Data engineer, privacy lead

When	What happens	Who does it
Weeks 2 to 6	Write about 1,000 real Globe questions with agreed answers, in Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano	Linguist, product owner
Weeks 2 to 8	Test five or six open models on those questions, and measure their energy use	Research lead
Weeks 3 to 10	Run two small pilots: help for care agents, and an assistant for Globe staff	Product owner, platform engineer
Weeks 4 to 10	Agree terms with partners and data owners; reserve space at STT GDC; decide whether to rent or buy the computers	Programme lead, platform engineer
Weeks 8 to 12	Build the business case with Globe's own numbers, and collect letters of interest from three outside clients	Product owner
Week 12	Gate 1 meeting: go or stop	Programme lead and sponsor

What it needs: about 10,000 hours of rented GPU time, one rented test server, pay-per-use AI for the pilots, and tools to track and test the models.

Gate 1 checklist (end of month 3). Everything must be true to continue:

- [ ] The best model meets its target on Globe's test questions in Filipino and Taglish
- [ ] The business case pays back, with an owner for each source of value
- [ ] At least three outside clients have signed letters of interest
- [ ] The privacy check approves the data sources
- [ ] Green computing space is confirmed at STT GDC Philippines
- [ ] Legal has approved the model's licence

If the answer is no: Globe stops, having spent at most US$1.17M. It keeps the data list, the test questions and the pilot results, and carries on with rented AI.

4. Phase 1: Build (months 4 to 9)

Goal: turn the best open model into Globe's three Filipino models, make them safe, and test them with staff and care agents.

Money: US$4.58M (₱286M). **Team:** grows to 16 people.

When	What happens	Who does it
Months 4 to 5	Sign licences for Filipino news, books and broadcast text	Programme lead
Months 4 to 7	Gather and clean the Filipino text, with personal details removed	Data engineers
Months 4 to 8	Filipino writers create thousands of example answers for care, network and office tasks	Linguists
Months 4 to 8	Build the router, plus the privacy and cost checks around the models	Platform engineers
Months 5 to 8	Train the small, medium and large models on Filipino, then on Globe's tasks	Research lead, model engineers
Months 6 to 9	Build the Filipino safety model, and try to break the AI on purpose to find weak spots	Safety lead
Months 6 to 9	Connect to the care systems that agents already use	Platform engineers, product owner
Months 7 to 9	Two pilots: an assistant for about 500 staff, and care chat with people checking the answers	Product owner
Months 8 to 9	Run the pilots on 8 rented GPUs at STT GDC, and publish the first model card	Platform engineers, energy analyst
Month 9	Gate 2 meeting: ready for customers?	Programme lead and sponsor

What it needs: about 140,000 hours of rented GPU time for training, 8 GPUs for the pilots, licensed data, and Filipino writers.

Gate 2 checklist (end of month 9). Everything must be true to continue:

- [ ] The medium (Core) model meets its targets in Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano
- [ ] Safety tests pass, with no serious problems left open
- [ ] The care pilot meets its targets for questions handled, handling time and satisfaction
- [ ] Cost and energy per answer are within target
- [ ] The model card is published and the privacy controls have been checked

If the answer is not yet: the team fixes the gaps and tests again within one to two months. The next money stays locked until then.

5. Phase 2a: Scale (months 10 to 18)

Goal: go live with customers, start selling to businesses, and add voice.

Money: US$5.09M (₱318M). **Team:** 16 people.

When	What happens	Who does it
Months 10 to 12	Set up the production computers (24 GPUs) at STT GDC's Fairview campus, with a back-up plan	Platform engineers
Month 12	Luntian goes live in customer care chat, one channel at a time	Product owner
From month 12	Globe Business starts selling private Luntian to banks, BPOs, hospitals and government agencies	Globe Business lead
Months 10 to 16	Record and transcribe Filipino speech; add Cebuano, Hiligaynon and Ilocano text	Data engineers, linguists
Months 13 to 16	First model refresh, using newer open models	Research lead
Months 13 to 18	A voice bot for the hotline, and a small model that flags scam texts	Model engineers
Months 13 to 20	Prepare for ISO/IEC 42001, the international standard for managing AI	Privacy lead
Month 15	Publish energy and carbon figures for each model	Energy analyst
Month 18	Gate 3 meeting: keep growing?	Programme lead and sponsor

What it needs: 24 GPUs (rented, or three bought servers), about 60 kW of locked space at STT Fairview, speech data and Filipino writers.

Gate 3 checklist (month 18). Everything must be true to release the last money:

- [ ] Signed business revenue is on target
- [ ] Care savings are on target, and customer satisfaction has held or improved
- [ ] Energy per 1,000 answers is at or below target
- [ ] A decision is taken: keep adapting open models, build Globe's own model from zero, or join a national effort

If the answer is not yet: the last money stays locked, except about US$0.11M a month to keep the live service running while the plan is fixed.

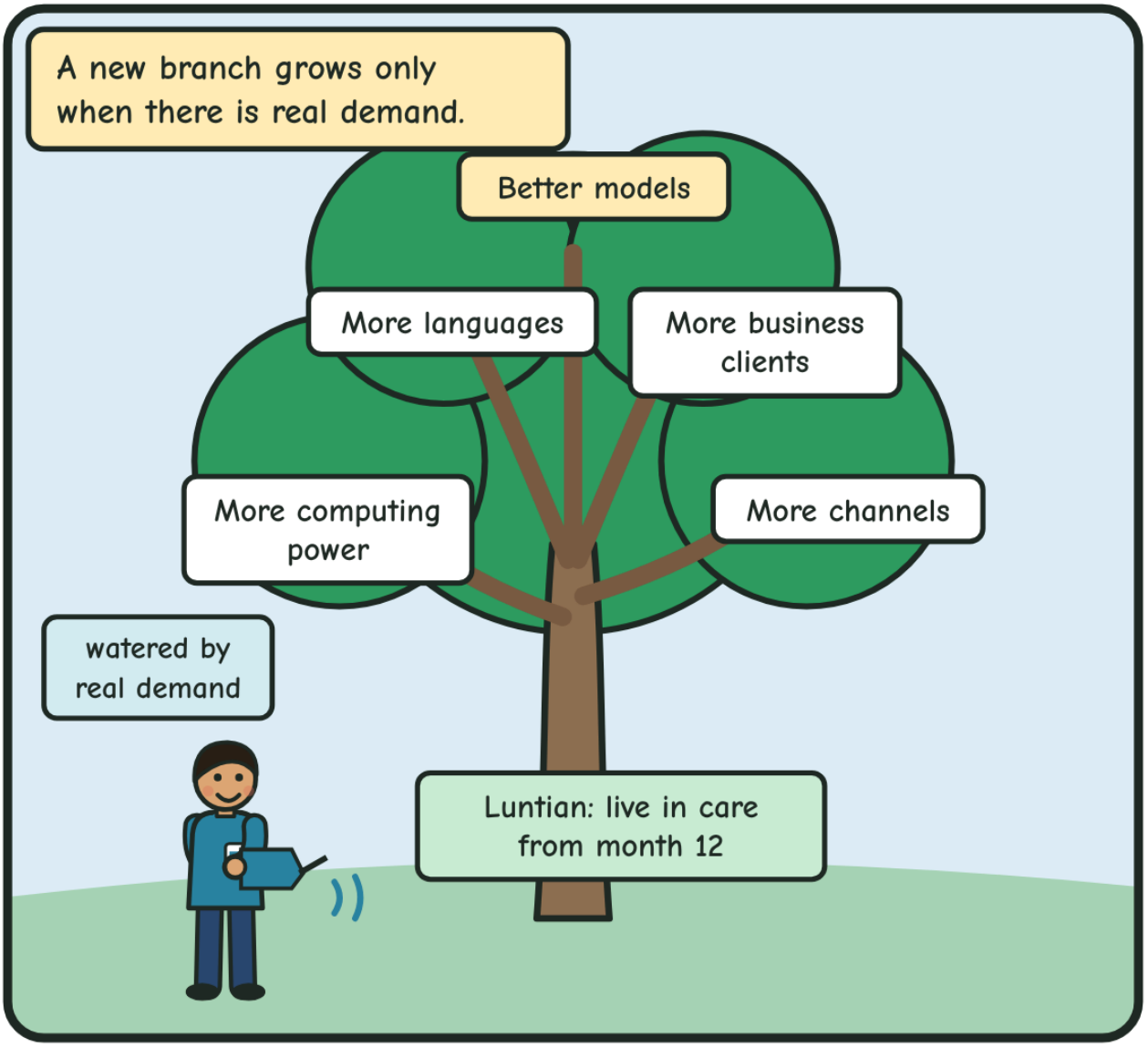
6. Phase 2b: Grow (months 19 to 24), then Year 3

Goal: make Luntian stronger, add business clients, and get Globe ready to run it alone.

Money: US$3.57M (₱223M). **Team:** 16 people.

When	What happens	Who does it
Months 19 to 21	Add a back-up site, so the service keeps running if one site fails	Platform engineers
Months 19 to 22	Second model refresh, using lessons from live use	Research lead
Months 19 to 24	Custom versions for the first business clients	Model engineers
Months 20 to 23	Teach the small model from the bigger ones, so more questions stay cheap	Model engineers
Months 22 to 24	Write the Year 3 plan: running costs, team and next steps	Programme lead
Month 24	Report Luntian's energy use in Globe's annual Integrated Report	Energy analyst

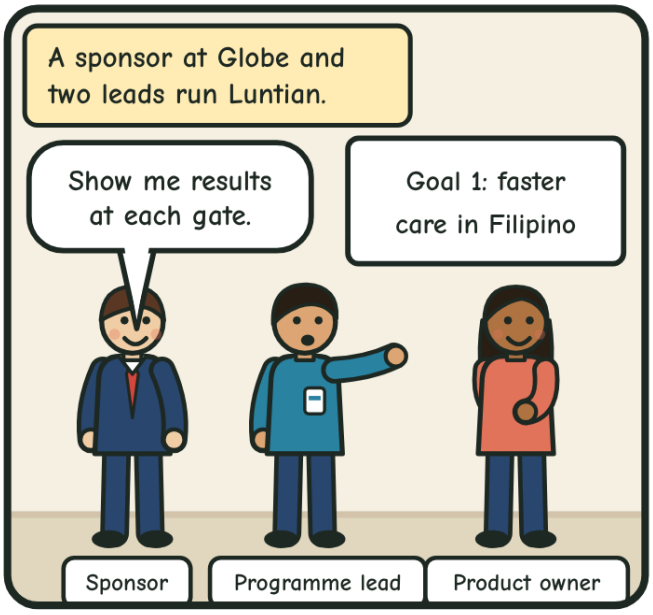
From Year 3: a run team of about 10 people keeps Luntian running and up to date for about US$4.8M a year. Luntian then grows only where there is demand: more computing power, more channels, more languages and more business clients.

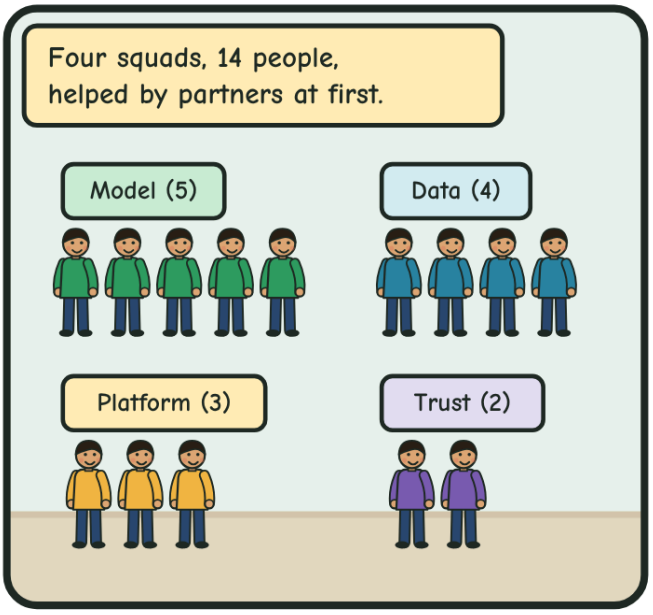


The picture shows the five directions. Each one starts only when there is real demand for it.

7. The team: who does what

Sixteen people build and run Luntian. Ten start in Phase 0, and the rest join in Phase 1.





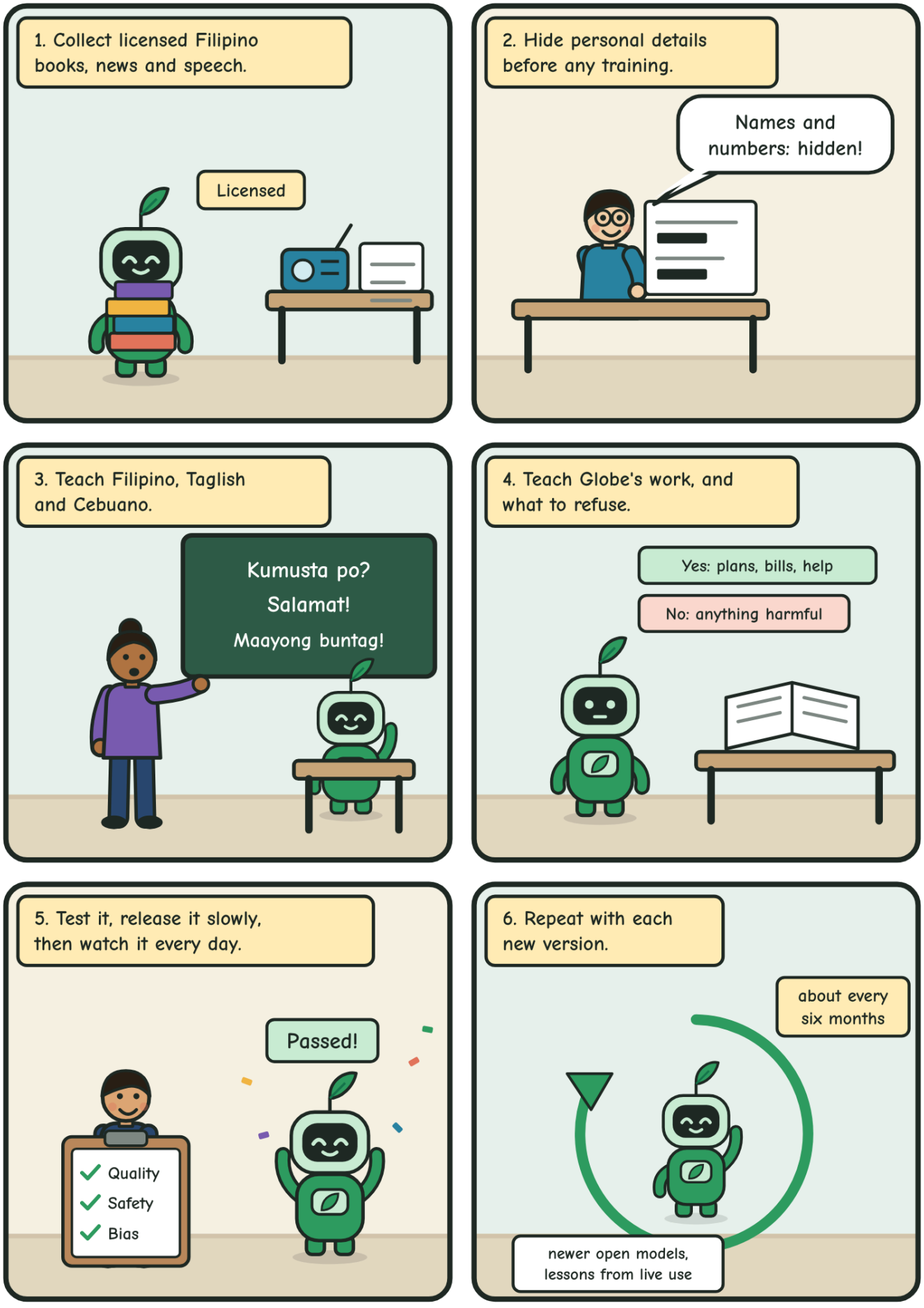
The table gives each role in one line, and when it joins.

Role	People	Their job, in one line	Joins
Programme lead	1	Runs the plan, budget, suppliers and checkpoints	Step 0
Product owner	1	Decides what Luntian does first, and makes sure people use it	Phase 0
Research lead	1	Chooses the models and how to train them	Phase 0
Model engineers	4	Train and improve the models	2 in Phase 0, 2 more in Phase 1
Data engineers	2	Collect and clean the data, and hide personal details	1 in Phase 0, 1 more in Phase 1
Filipino linguists	2	Write examples and test questions in Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano	1 in Phase 0, 1 more in Phase 1
Platform engineers	2	Set up and run the computers, the router and the monitoring	1 in Phase 0, 1 more in Phase 1
Safety lead	1	Tests the AI and keeps it safe	Phase 0
Privacy lead	1	Makes sure all data use follows the law	Phase 0
Energy and cost analyst	1	Tracks energy, carbon and cost per answer	Phase 1

Who helps them: Globe's procurement, security, legal, network and care teams, plus a senior sponsor who chairs every checkpoint. Partners such as AI Singapore (Singapore's national AI programme) and Philippine universities work alongside the team at first, then hand over so the skills stay inside Globe.

8. How the AI is trained, in five simple steps

Every version of Luntian goes through the same five steps, so quality, privacy and energy are checked the same way each time.



The five steps, in plain words:

1. **Collect.** Gather licensed Filipino text and speech, plus the Globe data that Globe may lawfully use.
2. **Clean and protect.** Remove junk and repeats, and hide names, phone numbers, account numbers and addresses. SIM registration records are never used.
3. **Teach Filipino.** Keep training the open model on Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano text, so it reads and writes like a local.
4. **Teach Globe's work and safety.** Train it on thousands of worked examples of Globe's tasks, and on what it must refuse.
5. **Test, release and watch.** Check it against the test questions and safety tests, publish a model card, roll it out slowly, and watch it every day.

The first round takes about four months. Later updates take about two months and happen about every six months. Anything that uses Globe's data stays in the Philippines.

9. What to buy or rent, and when

Rent while Globe is still learning. Buy the production computers only if they will be busy most of the time.

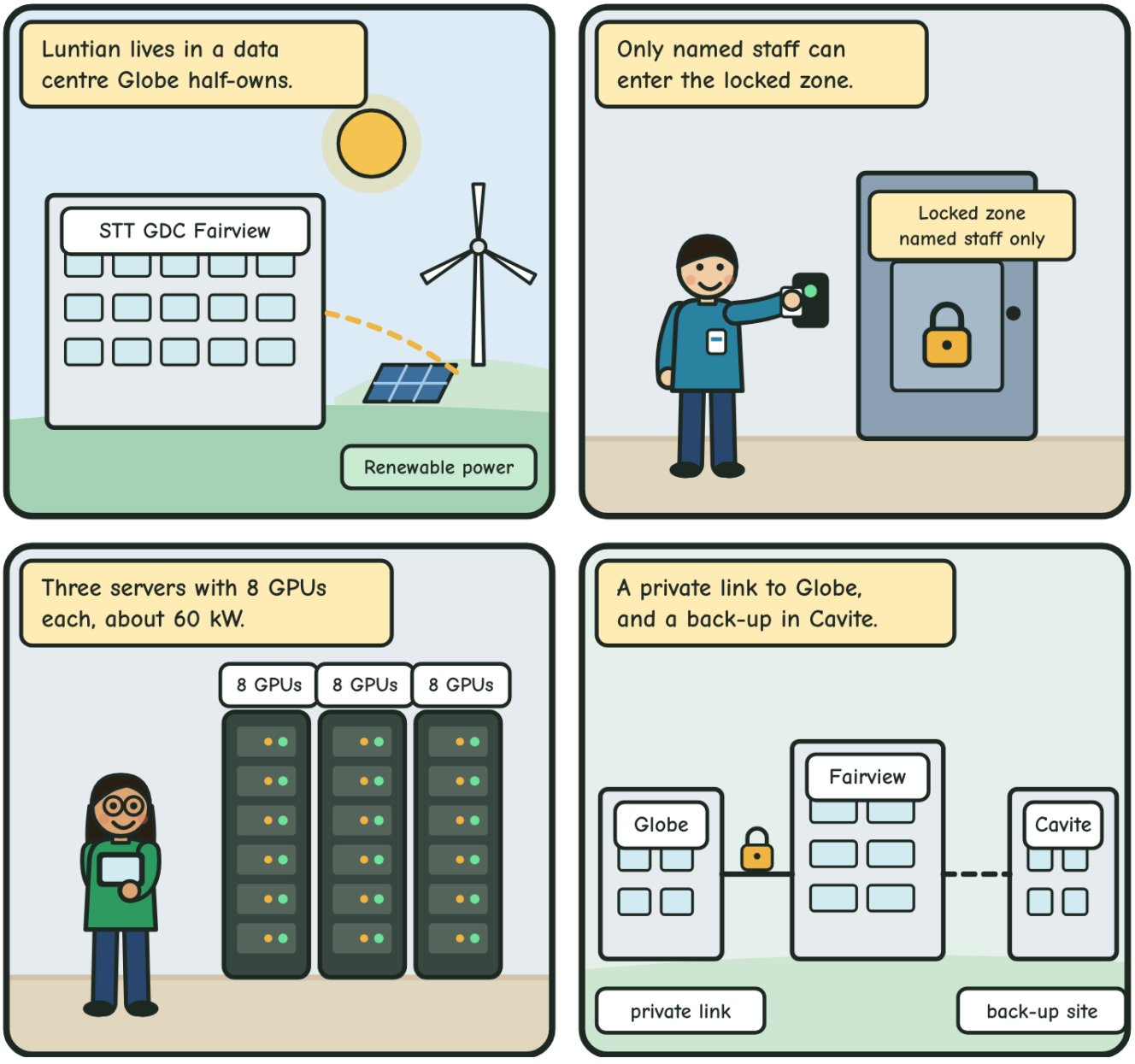
What	When	Rent or buy	About how much (upper side)
GPU time for training	Phases 0 to 2	Rent by the hour	US$1.86M to 2.07M over two years, depending on today's prices
A test server	Phase 0	Rent	US$60k
Pilot computers (8 GPUs)	Phase 1	Rent	Part of the US$243k Phase 1 serving budget
Production computers (24 GPUs)	Ready by month 12	Rent, or buy three servers	Rent: about US$1.14M a year. Buy: about US$1.5M to 1.8M once
Data centre space, about 60 kW	Reserve in Phase 0	Rent at STT GDC Philippines	Quoted by STT GDC
Filipino data licences	Phases 1 and 2	License	Inside the US$2.2M data budget
Writers who create examples	Phases 0 to 2	Contract	Inside the data budget
Software tools	Phase 0	Mostly free, open source	Inside the US$1.0M platform budget

What	When	Rent or buy	About how much (upper side)
Safety checks and audits	Phases 1 and 2	Buy as services	Inside the US$0.5M governance budget

How to buy: write down the needs, ask at least three suppliers to quote, compare the full three-year cost and delivery dates, sign with clear service levels, and test the pilot workload before the final payment.

Setting up the data centre

Luntian's computers sit in a locked zone that Globe rents at the Fairview campus of STT GDC Philippines, the data centre company Globe half-owns. Globe does not build a data centre.

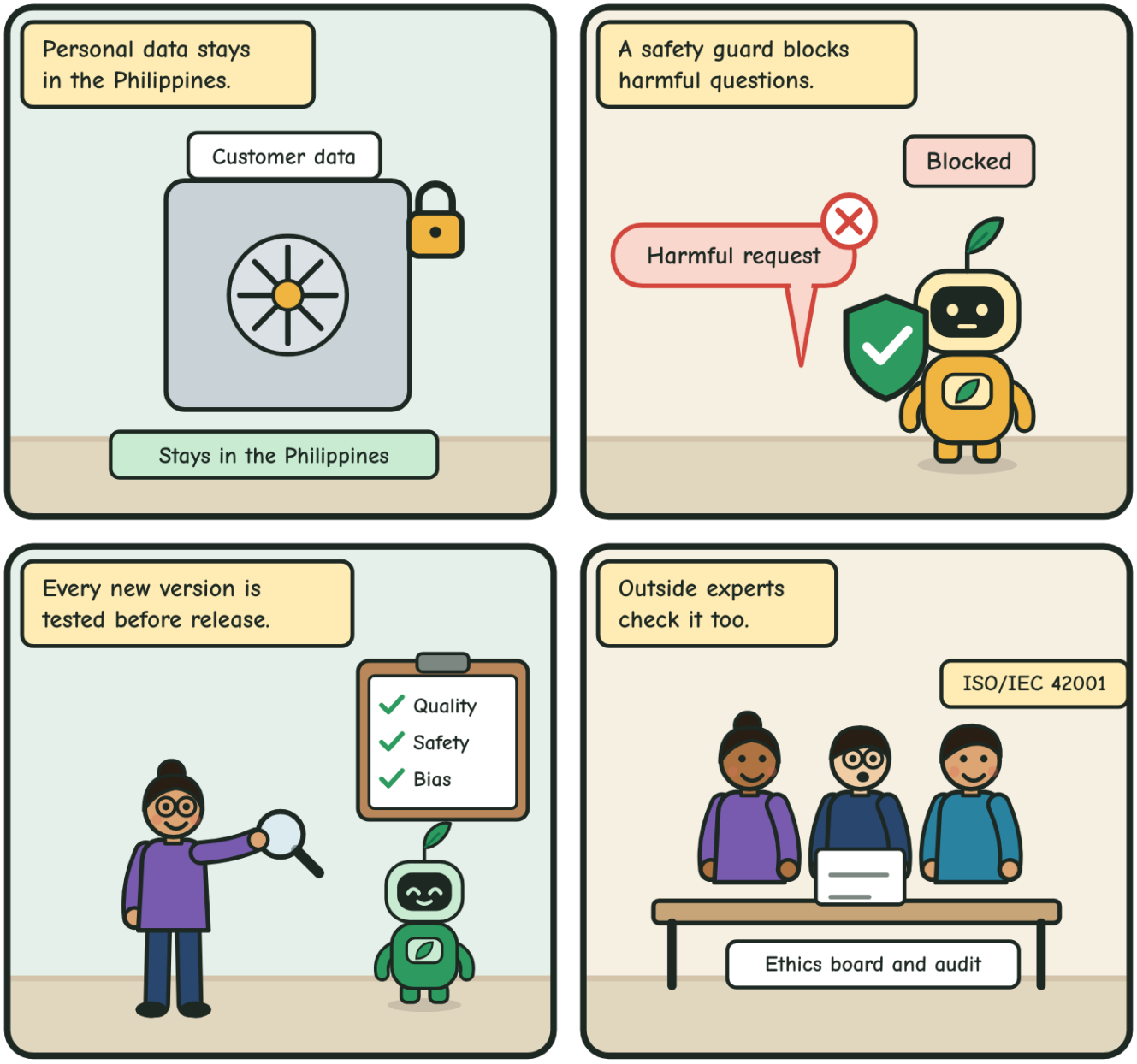


The set-up, step by step:

1. **Phase 0:** reserve about 60 kW of locked space at STT Fairview, and confirm the renewable power supply.
2. **Phase 0:** decide whether to rent the 24 production GPUs or buy three servers.
3. **Phase 1:** run the pilots on 8 rented GPUs.
4. **Months 10 to 12:** set up the production computers, storage and network, connect them to Globe by a private link, and test the back-up plan.
5. **Months 19 to 21:** add a back-up site, so the service keeps running if one site fails.
6. **At all times:** only named staff can enter the zone or reach the data, and there is no public internet path to the models.

10. Safety rules that apply at every step

These rules never change, whatever stage the project is in.



The eight rules, in plain words:

- **Personal data stays in the Philippines.** Anything that uses Globe's customer data is trained and run only in the Philippines.
- **Personal details are hidden first.** Names, numbers and addresses are removed before training, and SIM registration records are never used.
- **Only named people get in.** The servers sit in a locked, private area, and only named staff can reach them or the data.
- **Nothing goes live untested.** No model reaches customers until it passes the quality and safety tests.
- **People check risky answers.** High-risk answers are checked by a person, and every reply is logged.
- **The backup AI sees nothing private.** The outside AI, used only for rare hard cases, never receives personal data.

- **Privacy is checked again at every gate**, following the Philippine privacy regulator's rules for AI.
- **Energy and carbon are measured and published** for every model.

11. What could go wrong, and what we do

The two biggest risks are too little Filipino data and the AI not being as good as the best global AI. Both have a plan.

What could go wrong	What we do about it	Who owns it
Not enough Filipino data	License publisher and broadcaster archives, record speech, write examples, and test each language separately	Data engineers
Not as good as the best global AI	Release only when the targets are met, and send hard cases with no personal data to an outside AI	Safety lead
Newer open models arrive fast	Keep the data and tests reusable, and refresh every 6 to 9 months	Research lead
A privacy mistake	Privacy checks, hidden personal details, no SIM data, early talks with the privacy regulator, and a yearly outside audit	Privacy lead
AI experts are hard to hire	Work in joint teams with AI Singapore and universities, then hand over, and train Globe's own staff	Programme lead
Computer chips get scarce or expensive	Reserve space early, decide rent or buy at Gate 1, and keep the models small	Platform engineers
Businesses are slow to buy	Collect letters of interest by Gate 1, and hold back the last money until revenue is signed at Gate 3	Globe Business

12. Words you may not know

Word	What it means
AI model (LLM)	The "brain" behind tools like ChatGPT, which reads and writes text
Open model	An AI model that is free to download, use and train further, within its licence
Training	Teaching a model with examples so it gets better at a language or a job
GPU	A powerful computer chip used to train and run AI
Data centre	A secure building full of servers, with power and cooling
Router	The part that sends each question to the right-sized model
Gate	A checkpoint where leadership decides whether to release the next amount of money
Pilot	A small trial with real users before a full launch
Model card	A public fact sheet about a model: what it does, how it was tested and how much energy it uses
Red teaming	Trying to break the AI on purpose, to find weak spots before customers do
KPI	A number that shows whether something is working
Taglish	Tagalog and English mixed together, the way many Filipinos speak